

mobile handsets to ensure security and compatibility.

For personal usage, you can activate your BlackBerry service by contacting your service provider. You will get a subscriber ID or unique device ID. You can access your BlackBerry account online and add/delete/modify up to ten email accounts on your phone.

If you are using Windows Mobile and have an active data plan, you can configure your push email by going to 'programs' and then clicking 'ActiveSync.' From the menu, you can configure the server with server address and select the encryption. Then add your email account, just exactly the way you configure your Outlook.

Push email solutions also have a configuration wizard where on the handset you can configure the push email addresses and manage your account. This comes along with the client

Some BlackBerry-service-compatible phones

- Nokia 9300i SmartPhone
- Nokia 9500 Communicator
- Nokia E50, E61, E62, E65, E70
- Sony Ericsson P910i, P990i, M600i
- i-mate, 02, Krome, SP230, JASJAR, K-JAM, iPAQ

software.

User experience

The push email services or the so-called 'BlackBerry' services have made a great impact on time utilisation, instant access and performance at the corporate front. "BlackBerry service facilitates faster response especially when snap-decisions and faster access to information are needed," says Blackberry user Gautam Awasthi, general manager, marketing, EMG, Agilent Technologies. He feels that the service offers great bandwidth with almost real-time updation and reliability.

"The problem with some of the email accounts is that the activity on the mobile inbox is not reflected on your PC. For example, if you read an email on your phone, it would show unread on your PC. With Gmail, the syncing is great. In fact, the Google world is seamlessly integrated on the Nexus One," explains Fanindra.

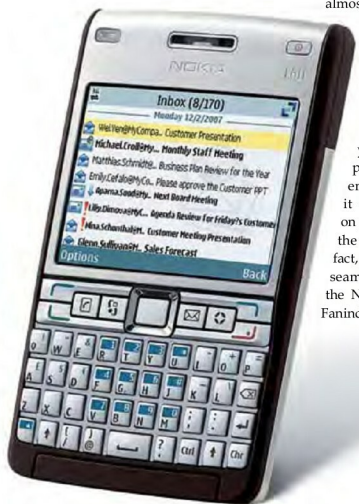
A Symbian S60 based Nokia user, Vimal Baid, CEO, Varsha Metal Industries, shares, "It is very easy to change the settings for the push email as it works on the same logic as Outlook using IMAP and SMTP protocol." He adds, "Though you can access email using mobile Web browser on your phone, the ease of operation cannot be compared to checking new mails and replying them using just one single click."

As push email works with an always-on or active connection, users experience issues with huge drain on the mobile battery. However, Gayakwad explains, "There are software optimisers to control the battery usage. One must keep the software updated and use the optimisers to check for optimal usage."

"The push technology increases your employees' productivity by empowering them to act upon information no matter where they are. Your employees never miss out on any time-sensitive information that is important for business," says Khandelwal.

Many push-enabled devices have built-in advanced security features. "If you accidentally leave your mobile somewhere or it is stolen, you can contact your IT admin to use 'remote wipe.' This will wipe out any data on your device that carries sensitive information," shares Khandelwal. "In case you are not using an enterprise solution, you should contact your service provider to stop further delivery of new mails. Also, you can have password to protect your phone and can configure the number of attempts," shares Gayakwad.

The downside of the technology is that you can never use the excuse, "Oh, I've not synced my email, I have not seen your message yet." The always-on expectation will never cut you off from work. ●



(Image courtesy: Tech2.com)

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